

Why we need forests

Besides providing homes and food for countless animals, trees supply us with a useful gift: wood. The first tools made by humans were probably sticks used for digging up roots. We still depend on wood and use it in dozens of different ways—to build houses, boats, furniture, toys, and much more!

Sap with a bounce

Rubber is the gummy sap that comes from rubber trees. It is collected by tapping—making cuts in the bark and gathering the sticky juice that flows out. This juice is then turned into rubber to make car and bicycle tires, soccer balls, and rubber bands.



Crafty cork

Cork comes from the bark of the cork oak—a tree that grows around the Mediterranean. It is used for flooring, placemats, and champagne corks.

Festive favorite

In some countries, conifer trees are decorated for Christmas. These trees were originally cut down where they grew in forests. Today they are grown in specially planted Christmas-tree farms.